Question	Government Answer
Section B.5 states the BPA may extend beyond the awardee's GSA schedule only if that schedule has option periods that, if exercised, cover the BPA PoP. For an offeror whose current MAS awarded period ends before 09/29/2031 but whose MAS carries unexercised, exercisable option periods extending well beyond it, does the Government consider B.5 satisfied at time of quote, or must the MAS already be extended through the full BPA PoP before award?	**BPA will be issued for a PoP through 09/29/2031. However, BPA Option Periods cannot be executed if the MAS' current Option Period has not been executed. The MAS must be in a valid status for the BPA periods to be executed. FAR 8.405-3 (d)(3) Contractors may be awarded BPAs that extend beyond the current term of their GSA Schedule contract, so long as there are option periods in their GSA Schedule contract that, if exercised, will cover the BPA's period of performance.**
For BPA labor categories that may not have a one-to-one equivalent on an offeror's 541611 schedule (e.g., Grants Management SME – Level II [High School + 3 yrs], Database/SharePoint SME, Trainer (Senior), Financial/Audit SME), will the Government accept a documented crosswalk to the offeror's most-relevant 541611 labor category, or is a MAS modification required prior to award? Please also confirm the B.6 provision that a teaming partner's GSA schedule pricing may be used.	**Per RFP Section E.9, Factor-5: The Government provided Price-Worksheet will include: (1) the applicable labor categories (which shall be cross-walked to the Offeror's most relevant GSA labor category), and (2) the number of hours for each labor category for the base period and option years.** **Additionally, E.9, Factor-5: All proposed rates for the prime and teaming partners/subcontractors will be evaluated to confirm they are in accordance with the proposed vendor's FSS contract rates**
What is the incumbent's name and contract number? Section 2.4.1 contemplates retaining the incumbent during transition — please confirm the anticipated transition-in duration.	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
Please confirm the staffing basis for the AFGP programmatic help desk (~1,800–2,000 inquiries/month): are the associated hours included within the Attachment III estimated hours, or ordered separately? What labor categories are expected to staff it, are any specific fire/EMS or grants certifications required, and is bilingual (Spanish) support needed?	**Actual hours will be detailed under individual orders. The number of inquiries per month (1800-2000) was included to assist vendor's in understanding the workload and determining relevant staffing plans for that requirement.** **Certification is not required. However, current knowledge and experience in the relevant disciplines (e.g., fire, emergency medical services, emergency management, communications, and grants management) is required as outlined in section 2.1 of the PWS solicitation.** **Bilingual support is not required.**
Are the Attachment III estimated hours (~140,180/year) a fixed common basis for price evaluation only, or indicative of expected Order volume? Is there any guaranteed minimum beyond the BPA's $100 minimum, and are the annual hour estimates uniform across all option years?	**Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**
At BPA start, what is the expected on-site presence at FEMA HQ (400 C Street SW) versus telework, and will Government workspace/equipment be available on day one?	**In-office presence will be identified for each individual call order at time of execution. Currently GPD contractors are working a hybrid schedule allowing for some telework.**
How soon will task orders be released upon award?	**RFQs for new orders will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
Can the Government inform what it would require from the BPA awardee in responding to orders post award? (i.e., technical and business volumes, quotes, etc.)	**RFQs for orders will be issued. RFQ will contain PWS/SOW of order effort and form-fillable LCAT pricing sheet to be returned. Orders will only be issued bilaterally.**
Does the government have an estimate regarding how many task orders will be released in the base year?	**It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level.**
Will a signed statement certifying that all FAR 52.212-3 representations and certifications in SAM.gov are current and valid satisfy the requirement, in lieu of a completed copy of 52.212-3?	**Per Section E.2.Copy of the Offeror's Representations, Certification, and Other Statements of Offerors or certification statement that all data in Sam.Gov is current/valid.** **NOTE: Offerors that have represented as other than small under NAICS 541611 are also not eligible for this award.**
Please confirm the OCI Mitigation Plan is required only from the apparent successful offeror after selection, and that no OCI representation is required within the initial quotation.	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.V2: OCI Mitigation Plan will be required from the apparent successful Offeror.**

ProVets BCS Alliance, LLC is an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture consisting of ProVets Consulting Group, an active SBA Certified 8(a) Participant and Managing Venturer, and its SBA-approved mentor. The Joint Venture also holds an active GSA Multiple Award Schedule contract under the applicable SIN and NAICS. Pursuant to 13 CFR §§ 124.513 and 125.8, SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé Joint Ventures are eligible to compete for 8(a) procurements when the applicable regulatory requirements are satisfied. Additionally, GSA eLibrary provides the following notice regarding Joint Venture certifications: "Attention: 8(a) JV Eligible, WOSB JV Eligible, SDVOSB JV Eligible and HUBZone JV Eligible contractors are self certified. Ordering agencies must confirm eligibility at the order level." In light of the above, and the solicitation requirement that quotations be submitted by SBA Certified 8(a) firms holding an active GSA Professional Services Schedule, would FEMA please confirm that an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture meeting the requirements of 13 CFR §§ 124.513 and 125.8 is eligible to submit a quotation under this solicitation, notwithstanding that the Joint Venture's GSA eLibrary profile may not currently display the 8(a) designation? If so, please confirm whether any additional documentation beyond the Joint Venture Agreement and SBA Approval Letter should be included with the quotation to facilitate FEMA's order-level eligibility determination.	**Competition is limited to offerors that are current SBA-certified 8(a) Program participants as of the proposal due date, hold an active GSA MAS contract under the applicable SIN covering NAICS 541611, and qualify as small business under NAICS 541611.** **In addition, the offeror's eligibility under applicable SBA and GSA MAS 8(a) requirements must support the issuance of competitive 8(a)-creditable orders through September 29, 2031.** **The Government reserves the right to verify an offeror's 8(a) Program status, MAS 8(a) Pool eligibility, applicable SIN, and size status with SBA and/or GSA prior to award.** **Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: Copy of the Offeror's Representations, Certification, and Other Statements of Offerors or certification statement that all data in Sam.Gov is current/valid.** **An 8(a) Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture is not ineligible solely because GSA eLibrary does not display an 8(a) MAS Pool designation, provided the JV otherwise satisfies applicable SBA/GSA eligibility requirements. As mentioned, Offerors must submit the documentation required by Section E.2.C, Volume II. The Government may request additional documentation or obtain SBA/GSA verification as necessary to confirm eligibility.**
Please confirm if letters of commitment for subcontractors should be included under Factor 1 if using a subcontractor Corporate Experience example, or if all subcontractor letters of commitment should be included in Volume 2, Business Quotation as outlined on page 56. Should the letter of commitment be duplicated within Volume 1, would it count toward the 40-page limit?	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol1: The Technical Volume shall not exceed forty (40) single-sided pages. Front Matter, resumes of key personnel, and letters of commitment do not count against page limitation. ...A letter of commitment for any proposed teaming partner and/or subcontractor which is used as one or more of the three (3) projects referenced under Corporate Experience.** **Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: The Business Volume shall include the following: Letters of commitment from teaming partners/subcontractors**
Please clarify if Column G should be the percent discount (e.g., 15%) or the dollar value discount (e.g., $15.00). If Column G is intended to be a percent, please update Column H to reflect the correct calculation. Currently, Column H is formatted as =SUM(GSA Rate-Percent Discount), and as such, it is not calculating the discount accurately.	**A0002 issued 7/23/2026 contained corrected Attachment III GPATS Price Schedule. Vendor input within Column G is the percent of discount vendor is agreeing to reduce their MAS LCAT rate.**
Would a cover letter be considered front matter? Please confirm if a cover letter would count toward the 40 page limit for the Technical Volume.	**Per RFP Section E.2. Volumes 1 and 2 shall be marked with the quotation number, and the offeror's name. Pages shall be numbered. Bookmarks are encouraged. Front matter (title pages, table of contents, cross- reference matrices, acronym lists, and glossaries) may be provided solely for easing evaluation, and do not count toward the 40-page limit for Volume 1.**
Within FAR Clause 52.212-5, FAR clause 52.219-16, Liquidated Damages - Subcontracting Plan is included. Can the government please clarify that this clause does not apply as small businesses are exempt from subcontracting plans?	**FAR 52.219-16, Liquidated Damages- Subcontracting Plan, is not applicable to this acquisition and will be unchecked in FAR 52.212-5.**
Within FAR Clause 52.212-5, FAR Clause 52.232-33 and 52.232-34 are both included. Can the government please clarify that only FAR Clause 52.232-33 should be included?	**FAR 52.232-34, Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer-Other than System for Award Management, is not applicable and will be unchecked in FAR 52.212-5. FAR 52.232-33, Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer-System for Award Management, remains applicable.**

Can the government please confirm, consistent with 13 CFR 125.11, that any work done as by the Prime Offeror through a joint venture will be considered?	**Yes, however see RFP Section E.9: Factor-1 Corporate Experience for exceptions:** **"...For the purpose of this evaluation factor "Corporate Experience" is defined as contracts, projects, jobs, and endeavors the Offeror and/or proposed subcontractor(s) have completed or are in the process of completing. Offerors shall present up to three (3) relevant contracts/projects, performed within the past five (5) years for clients (including federal, state, and local governments and commercial clients) as the prime or subcontractor, which demonstrate experience comparable to the PWS requirements for the BPA. A "project" is defined as a single contract or order. At least one of the projects must be with a client which has an organization with multiple directorates, divisions, branches, and/or sections including multiple layers within each directorate or equivalent.** **The Government will assess its confidence that the Offeror can successfully perform the requirements of the BPA based on the relevancy of the corporate experience and the anticipated benefits and/or risks to the Government as demonstrated in the three (3) example projects provided in accordance with the solicitation instructions. Greater consideration will be given to experience that is more relevant. Greater consideration will be given to experience of the prime Offeror than any proposed subcontractor(s). To be considered, the experience must have occurred within the past 5-years. No consideration will be given to experience of parent companies, subsidiaries, joint venture agreements, or any other legal entity other than the prime Offeror and proposed subcontractors with signed letters of commitment. The experience of the Protégé and mentor will be considered. The experience of the mentor will be considered but greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé since it must provide the project manager as well as ultimate project direction. Mentor-Protégé relationships shall be approved by the Small Business Administration.** **NOTE: 13 CFR 125.11(b)(i), "...When submitting an offer for a prime contract, a small business concern that has been a member of a joint venture may elect to use the experience and past performance of the joint venture (whether or not the other joint venture partners were small business concerns) where the small business does not independently demonstrate past performance necessary for award. The small business concern, when making such an election, shall..."**
Page 63 states that "no consideration will be given to experience of a parent company, subsidiaries, joint venture agreements, or any other legal entity other than the prime offeror and proposed subcontractors with signed letters of commitment." Will the government please clarify whether the offering contractor can utilize their experience, if they are the managing partner of a joint venture and performing work for the joint venture/on the project.	**Yes, however see RFP Section E.9: Factor-1 Corporate Experience for exceptions:** **"...For the purpose of this evaluation factor "Corporate Experience" is defined as contracts, projects, jobs, and endeavors the Offeror and/or proposed subcontractor(s) have completed or are in the process of completing. Offerors shall present up to three (3) relevant contracts/projects, performed within the past five (5) years for clients (including federal, state, and local governments and commercial clients) as the prime or subcontractor, which demonstrate experience comparable to the PWS requirements for the BPA. A "project" is defined as a single contract or order. At least one of the projects must be with a client which has an organization with multiple directorates, divisions, branches, and/or sections including multiple layers within each directorate or equivalent.**

	The Government will assess its confidence that the Offeror can successfully perform the requirements of the BPA based on the relevancy of the corporate experience and the anticipated benefits and/or risks to the Government as demonstrated in the three (3) example projects provided in accordance with the solicitation instructions. Greater consideration will be given to experience that is more relevant. Greater consideration will be given to experience of the prime Offeror than any proposed subcontractor(s). To be considered, the experience must have occurred within the past 5-years. No consideration will be given to experience of parent companies, subsidiaries, joint venture agreements, or any other legal entity other than the prime Offeror and proposed subcontractors with signed letters of commitment. The experience of the Protégé and mentor will be considered. The experience of the mentor will be considered but greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé since it must provide the project manager as well as ultimate project direction. Mentor-Protégé relationships shall be approved by the Small Business Administration. **NOTE: 13 CFR 125.11(b)(i), "...When submitting an offer for a prime contract, a small business concern that has been a member of a joint venture may elect to use the experience and past performance of the joint venture (whether or not the other joint venture partners were small business concerns) where the small business does not independently demonstrate past performance necessary for award. The small business concern, when making such an election, shall..."**
Please clarify whether the government will evaluate experience where a Prime Offeror cites their joint venture experience as a small business lead member. If the government is not going to consider a Prime Offeror's work performed under a joint venture, can they provide a basis for this decision?	**Yes, however see RFP Section E.9: Factor-1 Corporate Experience for exceptions:** **"...For the purpose of this evaluation factor "Corporate Experience" is defined as contracts, projects, jobs, and endeavors the Offeror and/or proposed subcontractor(s) have completed or are in the process of completing. Offerors shall present up to three (3) relevant contracts/projects, performed within the past five (5) years for clients (including federal, state, and local governments and commercial clients) as the prime or subcontractor, which demonstrate experience comparable to the PWS requirements for the BPA. A "project" is defined as a single contract or order. At least one of the projects must be with a client which has an organization with multiple directorates, divisions, branches, and/or sections including multiple layers within each directorate or equivalent.**

	The Government will assess its confidence that the Offeror can successfully perform the requirements of the BPA based on the relevancy of the corporate experience and the anticipated benefits and/or risks to the Government as demonstrated in the three (3) example projects provided in accordance with the solicitation instructions. Greater consideration will be given to experience that is more relevant. Greater consideration will be given to experience of the prime Offeror than any proposed subcontractor(s). To be considered, the experience must have occurred within the past 5-years. No consideration will be given to experience of parent companies, subsidiaries, joint venture agreements, or any other legal entity other than the prime Offeror and proposed subcontractors with signed letters of commitment. The experience of the Protégé and mentor will be considered. The experience of the mentor will be considered but greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé since it must provide the project manager as well as ultimate project direction. Mentor-Protégé relationships shall be approved by the Small Business Administration. **NOTE: 13 CFR 125.11(b)(i), "...When submitting an offer for a prime contract, a small business concern that has been a member of a joint venture may elect to use the experience and past performance of the joint venture (whether or not the other joint venture partners were small business concerns) where the small business does not independently demonstrate past performance necessary for award. The small business concern, when making such an election, shall..."**
Will the government confirm if the transition-in outlined in Section 2.4 of the PWS should be priced as part of the base period, or will there be a separate transition-in period at the first call order issued against the BPA?	**Per RFP PWS, Section 2.4.1 TRANSITION-IN. Once the notice to proceed is granted, contractor transition-in shall commence. The Contractor shall complete transition-in with no disruption in current GPD operations. To ensure the necessary continuity of services and to maintain the current level of support, GPD may retain services of the incumbent contractor for some, or all, of the transition period, as may be required as set forth in Orders.** **NOTE: New orders will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**

To ensure fair competition of actual SBA 8(a) companies, can the government please confirm an SBA 8(a) recertification and Small business certification is required at time of submission? Considering the substantial volume of 8(a)s that have lost certification in the past seven months, this will ensure the government gets applicable and valid SBA 8(a) participation and provides valid 8(a)s a fair opportunity.	**Competition is limited to offerors that are current SBA-certified 8(a) Program participants as of the proposal due date, hold an active GSA MAS contract under the applicable SIN covering NAICS 541611, and qualify as small business under NAICS 541611.** **In addition, the offeror's eligibility under applicable SBA and GSA MAS 8(a) requirements must support the issuance of competitive 8(a)-creditable orders through September 29, 2031.** **Offerors that have exited or graduated from the 8(a) Program prior to the quotation due date are not eligible for this award. Offerors that have represented as other than small under NAICS 541611 are also not eligible for this award.** **The Government reserves the right to verify an offeror's 8(a) Program status, MAS 8(a) Pool eligibility, applicable SIN, and size status with SBA and/or GSA prior to award.** **Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: Copy of the Offeror's Representations, Certification, and Other Statements of Offerors or certification statement that all data in Sam.Gov is current/valid.** **An 8(a) Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture is not ineligible solely because GSA eLibrary does not display an 8(a) MAS Pool designation, provided the JV otherwise satisfies applicable SBA/GSA eligibility requirements. As mentioned, Offerors must submit the documentation required by Section E.2.C, Volume II. The Government may request additional documentation or obtain SBA/GSA verification as necessary to confirm eligibility.**
Please confirm that the offeror must be certified as an 8(a) concern under NAICS 541611 at the time of proposal submission.	**Competition is limited to offerors that are current SBA-certified 8(a) Program participants as of the proposal due date, hold an active GSA MAS contract under the applicable SIN covering NAICS 541611, and qualify as small business under NAICS 541611.**
Would the Government consider making more than one award under the resultant BPA to provide FEMA with increased purchasing flexibility in support of the Grant Programmatic, Administration, and Technical Services (GPATS) requirement?	**No. Due to Agency needs and potential urgency for order issuance, this BPA will be issued as a single-award only.**
The solicitation states, "A 'project' is defined as a single contract or order." Since a BPA is not itself a contract, would a BPA with multiple orders meet the definition of a corporate experience "project"?	**Yes.**
Section 7.1 states that the Government will provide the workspace, equipment—including laptops and required software—and supplies necessary to perform the on-site portion of the contractor services required under the BPA, unless otherwise specified. What does the Government intend to provide to COR-approved, off-site contractor personnel whose work requires access to Government information technology systems?	**All contractors working on the BPA (both on-site and off-site) will be provided fully equipped government laptops with the required software once they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
Does the AFGP help desk currently exist? If so, where is it located, or is it operated remotely or virtually? If it does not currently exist, will the contractor be responsible for establishing it? Will the contractor be required to provide or maintain a database or help desk management software? If so, what software is currently used? During what hours must the help desk be staffed? Are response-time, service-level, or quality-assurance metrics currently in place? If so, please provide additional information regarding the help desk's operational requirements.	**The AFGP help desk currently exists and is located remotely. However, the location could changed due to the mandate for the federal government to return back to the office. This will be determined at time of call order. There is no official ticketing system used at this time to track help desk inquiries. Help desk hours are standard business hours (no evening or overnight shifts) and will be determine at time of call order. Current hours are Monday - Friday 8am-4:30pm EST. No quality assurance metrics at this time.**
The PWS identifies the BPA Project Manager as Key Personnel and requires the Project Manager to serve as the primary interface with the FEMA Contracting Officer and COR. Please clarify whether the proposed BPA Project Manager must be an employee of the prime offeror or may be provided by and employed by a proposed subcontractor.	**The Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager is a Key Person. If at time of proposal the Key Person is not currently employed by the offeror or subcontractor, a Letter of Commitment is required. Prior to or upon award, the Key Person must be an employee of the Prime. Resumes are limited to 3 pages each.**

The Factor 1 Corporate Experience instructions strongly discourage the use of "we" or "the team" because the Government must be able to identify the legal entity that performed the referenced work. Please confirm that this guidance applies specifically to the Factor 1 Corporate Experience narratives and does not prohibit use of those terms elsewhere in the Technical Quotation.	**This is specific to Vol1/Factor-1 only.**
The solicitation requires letters of commitment from proposed teaming partners/subcontractors in the Business Quotation and also requires a letter of commitment for any proposed teaming partner/subcontractor whose experience is submitted under Factor 1. Please clarify: 1.May one letter of commitment satisfy both requirements if it confirms the entity's commitment to participate in BPA performance and identifies the corporate experience being submitted on its behalf? 2.If separate letters are required, what information must be included in each letter? 3.Please confirm that all required letters of commitment, including letters supporting Factor 1 Corporate Experience, are excluded from the Technical Quotation's 40-page limitation.	**Competition is limited to offerors that are current SBA-certified 8(a) Program participants as of the proposal due date, hold an active GSA MAS contract under the applicable SIN covering NAICS 541611, and qualify as small business under NAICS 541611.** **In addition, the offeror's eligibility under applicable SBA and GSA MAS 8(a) requirements must support the issuance of competitive 8(a)-creditable orders through September 29, 2031.** **The Government reserves the right to verify an offeror's 8(a) Program status, MAS 8(a) Pool eligibility, applicable SIN, and size status with SBA and/or GSA prior to award.** **Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: Copy of the Offeror's Representations, Certification, and Other Statements of Offerors or certification statement that all data in Sam.Gov is current/valid.** **An 8(a) Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture is not ineligible solely because GSA eLibrary does not display an 8(a) MAS Pool designation, provided the JV otherwise satisfies applicable SBA/GSA eligibility requirements. As mentioned, Offerors must submit the documentation required by Section E.2.C, Volume II. The Government may request additional documentation or obtain SBA/GSA verification as necessary to confirm eligibility.** **1. A copy of the Letter of Commitment is required for both volumes.** **2. Refer to Subpart 9.6 - Contractor Team Arrangements.** **3. Per RFP Section E.2.B.V1: Page Limitation: The Technical Volume shall not exceed forty (40) single-sided pages. Front Matter, resumes of key personnel, and letters of commitment do not count against page limitation. Resumes of key personnel shall not exceed three (3) single sided pages and shall use a type-pitch that is no smaller than a standard 12-point font type. Resumes are not required for other than key personnel. However, the Government reserves the right to request resumes for non-key personnel to verify any applicable minimum qualifications.**
Factor 1 permits the prime offeror to submit experience it performed as either a prime contractor or subcontractor but states that experience derived from joint venture agreements will not be considered. Please confirm that this exclusion does not preclude an offeror from submitting its own experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved mentor-protégé joint venture, provided the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its subcontractor role, specific scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results. For clarity, the offeror would be submitting only the work it actually performed under the subcontract and would not be claiming the experience of the joint venture or another joint-venture member.	**The RFP excludes consideration of experience from joint venture agreements or other legal entities, permitting consideration of the prime Offeror's and proposed subcontractors' experience, including SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé experience.** **Therefore, subcontractor experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé joint venture may be considered if the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its own role, scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results.**

The solicitation states that greater consideration will be given to the prime Offeror's experience compared to that of proposed subcontractors, and that experience of parent companies, subsidiaries, affiliates, and joint venture agreements will not be considered. Please confirm whether experience performed by a proposed subcontractor under a signed letter of commitment will receive full evaluation credit if the subcontractor performed as the prime contractor on the referenced project.	**The RFP excludes consideration of experience from joint venture agreements or other legal entities, permitting consideration of the prime Offeror's and proposed subcontractors' experience, including SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé experience.** **Therefore, subcontractor experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé joint venture may be considered if the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its own role, scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results.**
Factor 2 requires demonstration of a sound understanding of GPD priorities and objectives. Beyond the PWS tasks, are there specific GPD strategic priorities, recent GAO/IG findings, or Resilience-level initiatives that the Government expects offerors to address in the Technical Approach?	**Recommendation is made to visit Grant Programs Directorate at https://www.fema.gov/about/offices/grant-programs**
Factor 3 requires demonstration of the ability to successfully manage numerous overlapping and simultaneous Orders. Can the Government provide any historical or anticipated data on the typical number of concurrent Orders, average Order size/duration, or peak surge periods under this BPA or predecessor vehicles?	**Estimated 5-8 orders is the initial projection and could increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level.**
The BPA Project Manager (Senior Level) is designated as Key Personnel and requires a minimum of 10 years recent and relevant experience plus a Bachelor's degree. Please clarify whether 'relevant' experience is limited strictly to grants management/programmatic support, or whether broader federal program management, acquisition support, human capital, or emergency management experience will be considered relevant.	**Grants management/program management experience as expected within the 541611 NAICS classification.**
Can the same individual be proposed as both the BPA-level Project Manager (Key) and serve as an Order-level Project Manager on individual Orders, or must the BPA Manager remain dedicated exclusively to BPA-level oversight?	**There is no restriction to BPA-level Project Manager (Key) also serving as an Order-level Project Manager on individual Orders**
PWS 5.1 states that levels of qualifications (e.g., Level 1, Level 2, Level 3) for roles or labor categories may be determined at the Order level. The Price Schedule, however, lists fixed LCATs with minimum education/experience. Please confirm that the Attachment III LCATs and minimum qualifications are the binding ceiling requirements for the BPA, and that Order-level adjustments cannot lower those minimums.	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: Offerors shall complete the Price Worksheet provided as Attachment III using the exact discounted labor rates proposed under Section B.6. Offerors shall not deviate from the labor categories, number of hours, and ODC amount specified by the Government in the price worksheet. The completed Price Worksheet will constitute the proposed amount.** **NOTE: LCAT requirements located with the Price Worksheet reflect the minimum qualification required.**
PWS 2.1.15 requires staffing and maintaining the Assistance to Firefighters Grant Programs (AFGP) programmatic help desk handling approximately 1,800–2,000 inquiries per month via phone and email. Please provide: (a) current hours of operation for the help desk; (b) whether the help desk is currently staffed by contractor or government personnel; (c) the expected minimum staffing level (FTEs) for this function; and (d) any knowledge management systems, scripts, or knowledge bases currently in use that will be made available to the contractor.	**Current hours of operation are Monday - Friday 8am-4:30pm EST. Help desk hours are standard business hours (no evening or overnight shifts) and will be determine at time of call order. At this time, the AFGP help desk consists of contractor staff only. There is no official system used at this time to track help desk inquiries.**
PWS tasks 2.1.16–2.1.18 require subject matter expertise in support of Research & Development awards under the Fire Prevention and Safety (FP&S) program and note that current knowledge in fire, EMS, emergency management, communications, and grants management is required. Please clarify whether the Government expects dedicated SME labor categories beyond the listed Grants Management SME Level II/III, or whether these requirements can be met by personnel mapped to the existing LCATs with demonstrated relevant experience.	**No SME labor categories are required beyond what is listed in the solicitation.**

Attachment III requires offerors to map each BPA LCAT to an 'Offeror GSA LCAT Title' and provide GSA Rate, Percent Discount, and Discounted Rate. Please confirm that the Government expects the exact GSA Schedule labor category title and corresponding published rate from the offeror's (or teaming partner's) MAS contract, and that the discounted rate becomes the ceiling rate for all Orders under the BPA.	**Correct. The Government expects the offerors exact GSA MAS LCAT Title, corresponding published Rate, and percent of discount.**
The Price Schedule shows 'Other Direct Costs and Travel' as N/A with no estimated amount. Please confirm that ODCs and travel will be proposed and negotiated only at the Order level (in accordance with Section B.7), and that no ODC or travel dollars should be entered in Attachment III for evaluation purposes.	**ODC/Travel is only authorized at the Call Order level and will be negotiated at that time.**
Section B.6 states that in the event additional/new labor categories are required, they shall be added through bilateral modification and must reflect the highest percent discount established under the BPA. Please confirm that offerors may not propose additional LCATs in their initial quotation beyond those listed in Attachment III.	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: Offerors shall not deviate from the labor categories, number of hours, and ODC amount specified by the Government in the price worksheet. The completed Price Worksheet will constitute the proposed amount.**
For evaluation of the FAR 52.217-8 Option to Extend Services, the Government will add six months of the offeror's final option period price. Please confirm the exact calculation method: will the Government take one-half of the total proposed amount for Option Period 4, or will it apply the final option year rates to one-half of the estimated hours for each LCAT?	**Quoted hourly LCAT rates for a 12-month Option Period-4 will be used to calculate an 18-month Option Period-4**
The Technical Volume is limited to 40 single-sided pages. Please confirm: (a) whether the cover page, table of contents, cross-reference matrix, and acronym list count against the 40-page limit; (b) whether double-sided printing counts as two pages; and (c) whether 11x17 foldouts for organizational charts count as two pages each.	**Per RFP Section E.2.B.V1 : Page Limitation: The Technical Volume shall not exceed forty (40) single-sided pages. Front Matter, resumes of key personnel, and letters of commitment do not count against page limitation. Resumes of key personnel shall not exceed three (3) single sided pages and shall use a type-pitch that is no smaller than a standard 12-point font type. Resumes are not required for other than key personnel.** **Header/Footer information (which does not include any information to be evaluated) may be included in the 1-inch margin space. Each 8 ½" by 11" inches "sheet" shall count as one page. Foldouts for complete spreadsheets and/or organization charts are permissible up to 11 inches by 17 inches and shall count as two pages. Double sided pages will count against the 40-page limit as two pages for each double-sided page. Pages submitted exceeding the limitations specified above will not be evaluated by the Government.**
All quotations must be submitted electronically via email and files shall not exceed 10MB. Please confirm the exact email address(es) for submission of the quotation and whether multiple emails (Part 1 of X, Part 2 of X, etc.) are acceptable if the total size exceeds 10MB.	**Per RFP Section E.2.A: Quotation submissions must include the solicitation number and Offeror name. All Quotations must be submitted electronically via email. Please note, electronic files must be submitted and shall not exceed 10MB or they will be rejected by the FEMA server. As necessary, files shall be submitted in parts in order to stay within the 10MB limit.** **Per RFP Section E.3: All questions and communications regarding this solicitation must be submitted in writing by 07/30/2026; 2:00 PM local time via email to the Contracting Officer, Christopher Rafuse, at Christopher.Rafuse@fema.dhs.gov. All vendor questions and the Government responses will be provide to all vendors who received the solicitation.**
Volume 2 requires 'All copies of any GSA Teaming Agreements.' Please clarify whether this refers only to formal Contractor Teaming Arrangements (CTAs) under the GSA MAS program, or whether any teaming/subcontracting agreements used for this response must also be provided.	**Per RFP Section E.2.B.V1: A letter of commitment for any proposed teaming partner and/or subcontractor, all copies of any GSA Teaming Agreements.**

Volume 2 requires completion of Section B.2 (Blanket Purchase Agreement Administrative Data). Please confirm the specific fields that must be completed at the time of quotation (Contractor name, MAS Contract Number, Unique Entity ID, Primary/Alternate POCs, Cognizant Contracting Office, etc.).	**Per B.2 BLANKET PURCHASE AGREEMENT ADMINISTRATIVE DATA** **A Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) is hereby established between (enter Contractor name)_____ and the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) under the following terms and conditions incorporated in this BPA and GSA Professional Services Schedule (PSS) contract: (enter MAS Contract Number)** **_____** **Contractor Primary Point of Contact: _____** **Contractor Alternate Point of Contact: _____** **Contractor Unique Entity ID: _____** **Cognizant Contracting Office: _____**
PWS Section 9.0 details background investigation requirements (Tier 1/2/4 depending on risk designation). Please clarify the expected timeline from identification of personnel to favorable adjudication, and whether the Government will accept personnel who already hold a favorable adjudication from another DHS Component or federal agency without requiring a new investigation.	**Completion of Tiered Employment Background Investigations vary depending on applicant's employment history, and prior access to DHS or FEMA information systems. PWS section 9.1 , outlines investigation requirements and application process.**
Please provide any available information regarding the incumbent contractor(s) currently performing similar work for GPD, the expected length of the transition-in period, and whether the Government anticipates a period of dual performance with the incumbent during transition.	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
The solicitation states that any assumptions that are considered unacceptable by the Government may result in the Offeror being removed from further consideration. Will the Government provide an opportunity to clarify or withdraw unacceptable assumptions prior to elimination, or will elimination be automatic upon identification of an unacceptable assumption?	**Per RFP Section E.2.A: Assumptions: Offerors must indicate if any assumptions have been made, conditions have been stipulated or exceptions have been taken with the terms and conditions of the solicitation and/or PWS. Assumptions and/or conditions related to the PWS shall be listed in the Technical Volume. Assumptions and/or conditions related to the BPA terms and conditions shall be listed in the Business Volume. If assumptions are not noted in the Technical Volume and/or Business Volume, it will be assumed that the Offeror's quotation reflects no assumptions for award and the offeror agrees to comply with all terms and conditions set forth in the solicitation. Offerors are advised that any exception(s) taken may adversely impact its evaluation rating. Any assumptions that are considered unacceptable by the Government may result in the Offeror being removed from further consideration.** **NOTE: Clarification/Exchanges may occur as necessary addressing relevance of past performance information (including adverse past performance) not previously responded to. Or minor clerical errors.**
PWS 1.5 states that work not required to be performed on site may be performed at an alternate contractor facility or via telecommuting with prior COR approval. Please confirm whether a fully remote staffing model is acceptable for Orders that do not explicitly require on-site presence, or whether a minimum percentage of on-site presence will be required across the BPA.	**Few orders will be fully remote. Some office presence is expected. However, this will be identified at time of order solicitation.**
Evaluation of Factor-1 Corporate Experience states "The experience of the Protégé and mentor will be considered. The experience of the mentor will be considered but greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé," however the sentence before states that "no consideration will be given to the experience of joint venture agreements or any other legal entity." Can the government please clarify if experience claimed from a mentor will be treated as Prime offeror experience or subcontractor experience, and will mentor experience be evaluated any differently than experience from a proposed (non-mentor) subcontractor?	**The RFP excludes consideration of experience from joint venture agreements or other legal entities, permitting consideration of the prime Offeror's and proposed subcontractors' experience, including SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé experience.** **Therefore, subcontractor experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé joint venture may be considered if the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its own role, scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results.**

The name of the Project Manager, and the name(s) of any alternate(s) who shall act for the Contractor in the absence of the Project Manager, shall be provided to the Government as part of the Contractor's proposal. Because the names of alternate(s) to the Key Project Manager shall be included in the proposal, are resumes for the alternate(s) required and would resumes submitted for alternate(s) be excluded from the 40 page count?	**Per RFP Section E.2.B.V1 : Page Limitation: The Technical Volume shall not exceed forty (40) single-sided pages. Front Matter, resumes of key personnel, and letters of commitment do not count against page limitation. Resumes of key personnel shall not exceed three (3) single sided pages and shall use a type-pitch that is no smaller than a standard 12-point font type. Resumes are not required for other than key personnel. Resumes are not required for other than key personnel. However, the Government reserves the right to request resumes for non-key personnel to verify any applicable minimum qualifications.**
Attachment III lists "Other Direct Costs and Travel" as N/A with no Government-specified amount, while Factor 5 states Offerors shall not deviate from the ODC amount specified by the Government. Please confirm that no ODC/travel dollars are to be proposed at the BPA level and that ODCs and travel will be established at the Order level.	**ODC/Travel is only authorized at the Call Order level and will be negotiated at that time.**
FAR 52.222-41/42/43 (Service Contract Labor Standards) are not marked as applicable in 52.212-5(c), yet several labor categories (e.g., Administrative Specialist, help desk support) appear to be non-exempt service employees. Please confirm whether SCLS applies to this BPA and, if so, provide the applicable wage determination(s).	**SCLS Clauses are incorporated within your GSA MAS and validated during Business Volume evaluation.**
Letters of commitment for teaming partners/subcontractors are referenced in both the Volume 1 (Factor 1) instructions and the Volume 2 content list. Please confirm whether letters of commitment should be included in Volume 1, Volume 2, or both, and whether any specific content or format is required.	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol1: The Technical Volume shall not exceed forty (40) single-sided pages. Front Matter, resumes of key personnel, and letters of commitment do not count against page limitation. ...A letter of commitment for any proposed teaming partner and/or subcontractor which is used as one or more of the three (3) projects referenced under Corporate Experience.** **Per RFP Section E.2.C.Vol2: The Business Volume shall include the following: Letters of commitment from teaming partners/subcontractors**
The Transition-In Plan is to be "incorporated within the initial proposal." Please confirm where the Transition-In Plan should be addressed (which volume and factor) and whether it counts toward the Technical Volume page limitation.	**RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
Please identify the incumbent contract number(s) and current contractor staffing levels, including for the AFGP programmatic help desk.	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. Help desk hours are standard business hours (no evening or overnight shifts) and will be determine at time of order solicitation. Current hours of operation are Monday - Friday 8am-4:30pm EST. Presently, the AFGP help desk consists of contractor staff only. There is no official system used at this time to track help desk inquiries (1800-2000 per month).**
Please confirm the anticipated on-site versus remote work mix for initial Orders at FEMA HQ, and confirm whether Government-furnished equipment (laptops/software) will be provided to all contractor personnel, including those approved for remote work.	**All contractors working on the BPA (both on-site and off-site) will be provided fully equipped government laptops with the required software once they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer. Work location will be determined with each individual call order.**
Given the 9/30/2026 start date, please confirm the anticipated processing timeline for Tier 1/Tier 2 suitability determinations, whether temporary eligibility to begin work may be granted during processing, and confirm reciprocity for personnel holding current favorably adjudicated DHS background investigations.	**Completion of Tiered Employment Background Investigations vary depending on applicant's employment history, and prior access to DHS or FEMA information systems. PWS section 9.1 , outlines investigation requirements and application process.**
The government states, "Greater consideration will be given to experience of the prime Offeror than any proposed subcontractor(s). " Please clarify how FEMA will evaluate prime versus subcontractor or mentor-protégé experience?	**The experience of the Protégé and mentor will be considered. The experience of the mentor will be considered but greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé since it must provide the program manager as well as ultimate project direction.**
Please clarify which volume the completed and signed SF1449 shall be a part of.	**Volume 2, Business Quotation**

Please clarify how SF1449 Blocks 23 and 24 should be completed because the BPA pricing is provided through Attachment III rather than line items displayed on the SF 1449.	**SF1449: blocks 21-24 are not applicable. Complete blocks 30a/30b/30c and submit with your Volume 2, Business Quotation.**
Please confirm the email address to which quotations must be submitted. The solicitation identifies Christopher Rafuse and provides christopher.rafuse@fema.dhs.gov for the Contracting Officer, but the quotation-submission instructions do not appear to clearly identify a separate proposal-submission mailbox.	**Per RFP Section E.3: All questions and communications regarding this solicitation must be submitted in writing by 07/30/2026; 2:00 PM local time via email to the Contracting Officer, Christopher Rafuse, at Christopher.Rafuse@fema.dhs.gov. All vendor questions and the Government responses will be provide to all vendors who received the solicitation.**
Please confirm whether quotations should be sent only to the Contracting Officer or copied to any Contract Specialist or other FEMA representative.	**Per RFP Section E.3: All questions and communications regarding this solicitation must be submitted in writing by 07/30/2026; 2:00 PM local time via email to the Contracting Officer, Christopher Rafuse, at Christopher.Rafuse@fema.dhs.gov. All vendor questions and the Government responses will be provide to all vendors who received the solicitation.**
Please confirm the required electronic file formats for each quotation component. Specifically, should Volume 1 and the narrative portions of Volume 2 be submitted as searchable PDF files, and should Attachment III be submitted in its original Microsoft Excel .xlsx format?	**PDF format is preferred for content packaging of volumes 1 &2. 70FA2026R00000007 Attachment III GPATs Price Schedule.20260729.xlsx issued via A00002 is the only acceptable file/format.**
Please confirm whether FEMA requires prescribed filenames for Volume 1, Volume 2, resumes, commitment letters, and Attachment III. If no mandatory naming convention applies, may offerors use a logical convention containing the offeror name, solicitation number, volume number, and document title?	**Required files should be named and in sequence, as rostered within the RFP. Quotation submissions must include the solicitation number and Offeror name. All Quotations must be submitted electronically via email. Please note, electronic files must be submitted and shall not exceed 10MB or they will be rejected by the FEMA server. As necessary, files shall be submitted in parts in order to stay within the 10MB limit.**
The solicitation excludes "Front Matter," key-personnel resumes, and letters of commitment from the 40-page Volume 1 limit. Please define the materials included within "Front Matter." Specifically, please confirm whether the cover page, table of contents, acronym list, glossary are excluded.	**Per RFP Section E.2.A: Front matter (title pages, tables of contents, cross-reference matrices, acronym lists, and glossaries) may be provided solely for the purpose of easing evaluation.** **NOTE: Front matter examples includes: title pages, letter of transmittal, table of contents/list of figures, list of terms, executive summary.**
Please provide the anticipated percentage of work to be performed onsite at FEMA Headquarters, at other FEMA locations, and remotely or at contractor facilities.	**Few orders will be fully remote. Some office presence is expected. However, this will be identified at time of order solicitation.**
Please confirm whether remote work approval will be established at the BPA level or separately for each Order.	**No, remote work will not be determine at the BPA level, only at the call order level.**
Please confirm whether FEMA will provide laptops, software licenses, and remote-access credentials to all personnel assigned to Orders, including personnel working remotely, or whether contractors must provide equipment for offsite performance.	**All contractors working on the BPA (both on-site and off-site) will be provided fully equipped government laptops with the required software once they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
What pricing validity period should contractors include with bids?	**The full performance period of the BPA.**
What is the anticipated Transition-In period of performance?	**RFQs for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**

1.Artificial Intelligence: The PWS states that artificial intelligence may not be used without Contracting Officer authorization. Does this restriction apply solely to AI capabilities, or may contractors use conventional automation technologies (e.g., Microsoft Power Apps, Power Automate, Power BI, SharePoint workflows, robotic process automation, and similar rule-based workflow/reporting tools) in performing the BPA, provided they do not utilize AI capabilities?	**Per Section C of the RFP: The Contractor will not use or deploy the use of Artificial Intelligence, as defined by 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), unless expressly authorized by the Contracting Officer. The term ''artificial intelligence'' means a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments. Artificial intelligence systems use machine and human-based inputs to-** **(A) perceive real and virtual environments;** **(B) abstract such perceptions into models through analysis in an automated manner; and** **(C) use model inference to formulate options for information or action."** **NOTE: Contracting Officer approval will be required if automation technologies used by the contractor during performance of this BPA fitting the AI criteria identified above. This is not applicable for Government provided laptops with the required software, they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
2.BPA Past Performance: For Factor 1 – Corporate Experience, may an Offeror submit a Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA) as a project reference, or must references be limited to individual orders/task orders issued under a BPA?	**Yes, BPA experience with the issuance of orders with deliverables will be considered.**
3.Letters of Commitment: Section E.2 (Volume 2 Business Instructions) requires Letters of Commitment from teaming partners/subcontractors, while Factor 1 (Corporate Experience) also requires a Letter of Commitment for any subcontractor whose project is submitted as a Corporate Experience reference. Please confirm whether a single Letter of Commitment included in the Business Volume satisfies both requirements.	**Letters of commitment from teaming partners/subcontractors/JV is required for both Volumes**
4.Historical Workload: Can the Government provide historical information regarding the approximate annual number of Orders, average Order value, typical period of performance, and/or approximate number of concurrent active Orders anticipated under the BPA?	**It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level. All existing orders have a period of performance of 12 months.**
5.Remote vs. Onsite Work: Can the Government provide an estimated distribution of anticipated work between onsite, hybrid, and remote performance, or will these requirements be established at the individual Order level?	**A decision on office presence will be identified for each individual call order at time of execution. Currently GPD contractors are working a hybrid schedule allowing for some telework but also in office presence.**
6.Pricing Workbook: Attachment III labels column G "Percent Discount" and formats it as a percentage, but column H uses =SUM(F-G), which subtracts the percentage value directly from the GSA rate. Request confirmation whether G should contain a dollar discount or whether H should calculate GSA Rate × (1 − Percent Discount). Do not independently modify the Government formula without direction. (Attachment III, e.g., G8:H8 and corresponding rows).	**A0002 issued 7/23/2026 contained corrected Attachment III GPATS Price Schedule. Vendor input within Column G is the percent of discount vendor is agreeing to reduce their MAS LCAT rate.** **NOTE: The completed Price Worksheet will constitute the proposed amount.**
1.The pricing sheet provided by the government mentions "Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager". Are there any additional Key Personnel expected by the government?	**Not at this time**
3.On page 74, section 3.0 (Deliverables), please confirm the PWS reference to 6.2 to clarify if a Quality Control Plan should be submitted with the initial proposal submission or only post award.	**Draft Quality Control Plan will be required from the apparent successful Offeror at time of Post Award Conference. Final version within 15 business days after Post Award Conference.**
Would FEMA consider a BPA as a relevant corporate experience past performance submission, representing multiple task or orders, to allow FEMA to see a bidder's experience managing a program of similar size, scope, and complexity to GPATS?	**Yes, BPA experience with the issuance of orders with deliverables will be considered.**
Should the completed SF 1449 be included within Volume 2 of the final proposal submission?	**Yes**

P. 55 of the RFQ indicates, "A letter of commitment for any proposed teaming partner and/or subcontractor which is used as one or more of the three projects referenced under Corporate Experience." Should the executed letters of commitment be organized in Volume 1 of the submission? If so, do the subcontractor LOC's count against the 40 page limit?	**Volume 1 Technical Quotation: letters of commitment required and does not count against page limitation. Corporate experience does count against page limitation.** **NOTE: Volume 2 Business Quotation: letters of commitment required. Volume 2 has no page limit.**
1. Does the use of "we" or "the team" apply only to the Corporate Experience section and the referenced past projects?	**Correct.**
2. Does the Government require offerors to include a completed SF 1449 with their quotation? If so, please indicate the volume in which it should be included.	**Yes, submit with the Volume 2 Business Quotation.**
3. Section B.5 states that the ordering period begins on the effective date of award, while the Performance Work Statement identifies September 30, 2026, as the beginning of the base period. Please confirm the anticipated effective date and whether pricing should be based on the exact dates provided in Attachment III.	**Effective date of BPA award is 09/30/2026. Base period of performance start date is 09/30/2026 as detailed within Attachment III.**
4. Please provide the Government's current estimate of the percentage of work expected to be performed onsite at FEMA Headquarters versus remotely during the base period.	**Few orders will be fully remote. Some office presence is expected. However, this will be identified at time of order solicitation.**
5. Will the Government require the BPA Project Manager to work onsite full-time, periodically, or only upon request?	**Preferably onsite full-time with periodic telework.**
6. Please confirm that the estimated hours provided in Attachment III are evaluation quantities only and do not represent a guaranteed minimum level of effort or an anticipated immediate staffing requirement.	**The estimated amount of this Blanket Purchase Agreement is $95,000,000 (inclusive of options). This amount is not guaranteed.** **Note: Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**
7. Does the Government anticipate issuing orders requiring the full estimated annual labor mix, or are the estimated hours intended solely to establish standardized pricing across offerors?	**Individual orders will be solicited as requirements are identified. The Periods of Performance may vary depending on urgency or Agency requirements at that time. Steady-state orders are issued annually.**
8. May a single GSA labor category be mapped to more than one BPA labor category when the GSA category's education, experience, and functional description satisfy the requirements of each applicable BPA category?	**Yes. However they must meet the minimum qualifications as identified.**
9. If an offeror's GSA labor category includes minimum qualifications that exceed those of the corresponding BPA labor category, may the GSA category be proposed without modification?	**Per Section B.6. of the RFP: The agreed upon labor rates are fully burdened (inclusive of all indirect costs and profit) and are inclusive of any offered discounts. Only the labor categories and rates set forth herein may be used during the performance of this agreement. In the event additional/new labor categories are required, the contracting officer is to be notified, and if approved, the required labor category shall be added to this BPA through a bi-later modification. Any additional or new labor categories added must reflect the highest percent discount established under the BPA.**
10. Please confirm whether every labor category listed in Attachment III must be available at the time of quotation submission, even if a particular category may not be utilized under an initial order.	**Contractor personnel required for the performance and execution of orders are not required to be available at time of quotation.**
11. May labor categories be provided through a GSA Contractor Team Arrangement, a subcontractor, or a combination of both, provided that the proposed pricing represents a complete GSA solution?	**Yes**
12. May an ongoing project be submitted as a corporate-experience example when the majority of the relevant work was performed during the past five years, but the original contract began before the five-year lookback period?	**Yes. 5 years maximum is the measured criteria.**

13. For an IDIQ contract or BPA, does the Government consider each task order to be a separate "project," or may the overarching vehicle be submitted as one corporate-experience example when multiple task orders collectively demonstrate the relevant scope?	**Contract vehicles are creditable however more emphasis is placed on orders with obligation and deliverables.**
14. Factor 1 permits offerors to submit up to three corporate-experience projects. Please confirm that submission of three projects is not mandatory and that an offeror submitting fewer than three projects will remain eligible for evaluation, subject to FEMA's assessment of the relevance and breadth of the experience presented.	**Three relevant contracts/projects is the maximum for submission. Proposal will be evaluated if less than three are submitted.**
15. Will the Government consider contract magnitude, annual staffing levels, and the number of simultaneous projects when evaluating relevance, even though the solicitation does not establish a specific minimum contract value?	**Yes.**
16. Does FEMA expect the Technical Approach to address each PWS task area and subtask separately, or may offerors organize their approach around an integrated operating methodology?	**Per RFP Section E.2.B.V1: The Government will assess its confidence that the Offeror can successfully perform the requirements of the BPA based on the proposed Technical Approach. Consideration will be given to : (1) the thoroughness of the approach which shall demonstrate a sound understanding of these requirements and GPD priorities and objectives, (2) the merit of the approach which shall be tailored for the appropriate scope of work including the anticipated benefits and performance risks, (3) demonstrated use of best industry practices to accomplish the work, (4) how the approach will enhance GPD's ability to support internal and external stakeholders.** **NOTE: Volume 1 Technical Quotation: has a 40-page limitation.**
17. Other than the BPA Project Manager, does FEMA anticipate designating any additional BPA-level positions as key personnel at the time of award?	**Not at this time**
18. May an offeror voluntarily designate additional key personnel? If so, would substitutions involving voluntarily designated personnel be subject to the same approval requirements as Government-designated key personnel?	**Attachment III BPA LCATs cannot be modified. LCATs at the order level identify all personnel (by count, title and labor hours) needed for the acquisition.**
19. Is a letter of commitment required for a proposed key person who is employed by a teaming partner or subcontractor, or only for personnel who are not currently employed by any member of the proposed team?	**Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager (key person) must be an employee of the Prime.**
20. Does FEMA anticipate requiring named personnel for all estimated labor categories at the time of BPA award, or only for the BPA Project Manager position?	**Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager (key person) is the only named person required.**
21. Will FEMA permit contingent hires to be included in the staffing and surge plan without providing résumés, provided that such individuals are not proposed as key personnel?	**Only the Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager (key person) resume is required.**
22. What suitability or public-trust risk level does FEMA anticipate for the BPA Project Manager and the principal labor categories?	**Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager: Bachelors Degree, 10 years experience, completion of appropriate Tiered Employment Background Investigation.**
23. Does FEMA anticipate imposing any citizenship, residency, or minimum continuous U.S. presence requirement for contractor personnel who will access FEMA systems or sensitive grant-related information?	**In-office presence will be identified for each individual call order at time of execution. Currently GPD contractors are working a hybrid schedule allowing for some telework. Completion of appropriate Tiered Employment Background Investigation. Agency GFE is prohibited outside the continental United States.**
24. The PWS requires the Transition-In Plan to be incorporated into the initial quotation. Please confirm whether this plan is included within the 40-page Technical Volume limitation and identify the evaluation factor under which it should be presented.	**RFQs for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**

25. Please confirm whether the accounting-system narrative must demonstrate compliance with a specific standard, audit, or approval, or whether a description of the offeror's timekeeping, labor distribution, cost tracking, invoicing, and internal controls will be sufficient.	**This requirement has been relaxed to only require the minimum information necessary for the Contracting Officer to determine that the Offeror's accounting system is adequate for the resultant BPA and orders as required by Federal Acquisition Regulation. The Offeror shall submit a description of their accounting system and how it will adequately provide timely and reliable tracking and reporting of labor hours and other direct costs incurred under call orders.** **NOTE: Only the accounting system of the apparent successful Offeror will be evaluated.**
26. Please confirm the required escalation methodology for option-year labor rates and whether offerors may propose different escalation percentages by labor category.	**Offerors shall complete the Price Worksheet provided as Attachment III using the exact discounted labor rates proposed under Section B.6. Offerors shall not deviate from the labor categories, number of hours, and ODC amount specified by the Government in the price worksheet. The completed Price Worksheet will constitute the proposed amount. Please note Offerors shall provide most favorable GSA/Supply Schedule discounts. BPA discounts are highly encouraged. A complete pricing solution under GSA's Professional Service Schedule must be provided. Offerors who fail to provide a complete GSA** **solution may not be considered. Volume 2 has no page limit. Offeror's who fail to provide complete information may not be considered for award.**
27. Please confirm whether the percent-discount field should reflect the discount from the current GSA ceiling rate applicable to each respective performance period.	**This is competitively solicited, your best discount is requested.**
28. Please clarify how offerors should account for the six-month extension authorized under FAR 52.217-8 in Attachment III, as the workbook includes the base period and four option periods but does not contain a separate extension-period schedule.	**Per RFP Section E.9: The method for calculating the option price will be to take the proposed amount for the last option period (based on the completed Price-Worksheet) and extend the estimated price for up to an additional six months of performance, in accordance with the maximum time available for extension under the clause. This will give the total evaluated price for the base period of performance and all options contained in the BPA.**
29. Please provide the anticipated number of orders, average order value, and average period of performance expected during the first BPA year, if this information is available.	**It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level. All existing orders have a period of performance of 12 months and vary from $900K - $3M.**
30. What is the anticipated frequency of expedited order requests requiring quotation responses within 48 hours?	**There is a rare expectation that solicitations for orders will require a 48hr award.**
31. Does the prohibition on the use or deployment of artificial intelligence apply to ordinary commercial software features that contain embedded AI functionality, including Microsoft 365 features, grammar tools, transcription tools, or analytics capabilities, unless specifically approved by the Contracting Officer?	**Per Section C of the RFP: The Contractor will not use or deploy the use of Artificial Intelligence, as defined by 15 U.S.C.** **9401(3), unless expressly authorized by the Contracting Officer. The term ''artificial intelligence'' means a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments. Artificial intelligence systems use machine and human-based inputs to-** **(A) perceive real and virtual environments;** **(B) abstract such perceptions into models through analysis in an automated manner; and** **(C) use model inference to formulate options for information or action."** **NOTE: Contracting Officer approval will be required if automation technologies used by the contractor during performance of this BPA fitting the AI criteria identified above. This is not applicable for Government provided laptops with the required software, they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
32. Section E.2 requires electronic submission by email; however, the solicitation does not appear to identify the authorized email address or addresses for quotation submission. Please confirm the required submission recipient or recipients.	**Per RFP Section E.3: All questions and communications regarding this solicitation must be submitted in writing by 07/30/2026; 2:00 PM local time via email to the Contracting Officer, Christopher Rafuse, at Christopher.Rafuse@fema.dhs.gov. All vendor questions and the Government responses will be provide to all vendors who received the solicitation.**

33. Section E.2 states that electronic files may not exceed 10 MB and that quotations may be submitted in parts. Please confirm whether the 10 MB limitation applies to each individual email, each attachment, or the complete quotation. Additionally, please confirm whether FEMA will accept sequential emails identified as “Part 1 of X,” “Part 2 of X,” and so forth.	**Per RFP Section E.2.A: Quotation submissions must include the solicitation number and Offeror name. All Quotations must be submitted electronically via email. Please note, electronic files must be submitted and shall not exceed 10MB or they will be rejected by the FEMA server. As necessary, files shall be submitted in parts in order to stay within the 10MB limit.**
34. Attachment III instructs offerors not to deviate from the Government-provided Other Direct Costs amount; however, the “Other Direct Costs and Travel” row does not appear to include an estimated amount. Please confirm whether offerors should enter $0 for ODCs and travel for evaluation purposes or whether FEMA intends to issue a revised Price Worksheet containing the applicable amount.	**ODC/Travel is only authorized at the Call Order level and will be negotiated at that time.**
35. PWS Section 7 states that Government resources may be provided, while Section 1.2 generally requires the contractor to furnish the equipment and facilities necessary to perform the work. Please clarify whether FEMA-issued equipment will be provided to personnel who require access to FEMA systems, the Grants Management Modernization system, SharePoint, or sensitive information.	**All contractors working on the BPA (both on-site and off-site) will be provided fully equipped government laptops with the required software once they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
Sections B.11 and B.12 require statements of actual cost, provisional indirect billing rates under FAR Part 42.7, fee and retainage information, and current and cumulative cost-element reporting. Please confirm that these requirements do not apply to FFP orders and revise the solicitation to provide separate invoicing instructions for FFP and T&M orders.	**RFP Sections B.11 and B.12 are boilerplate instructions for pursuing orders. Orders shall be issued with FFP Labor. On seldom occasion, an order may contain T&M Other Direct Costs (travel).**
For an FFP order, please confirm that invoices will be based on the fixed prices, units, deliverables, milestones, or payment schedule established in the order and will not require disclosure of actual labor costs, indirect rates, profit/fee, or actual subcontractor costs.	**All orders issued shall identify labor as FFP. Deliverables/milestones will be detailed within the order PWS/order schedule. Disclosure of actual labor costs, indirect rates, profit/fee, or actual subcontractor costs is not required.**
For T&M orders, please confirm that labor invoices will show the applicable BPA labor category, hours performed, contractual hourly rate, and extended amount, with materials, travel, and other approved ODCs supported in accordance with FAR 52.212-4 Alternate I. Please confirm whether the cost-reimbursement fee, retainage, provisional indirect-rate, and completion-voucher instructions will be deleted.	**RFP Sections B.11 and B.12 are boilerplate instructions for pursuing orders. Orders shall be issued with FFP Labor. On seldom occasion, an order may contain T&M Other Direct Costs (travel) therefore requiring FAR 52.212-4 Alternate I.**
Does the requested accounting-system description require a DCAA-approved or otherwise Government-approved accounting system, or only a system capable of segregating and reporting labor hours and ODCs by order, CLIN, task, and LCAT? Could the Government please provide specific requirements to address accounting-system description requirements for the business volume?	**This requirement has been relaxed to only require the minimum information necessary for the Contracting Officer to determine that the Offeror's accounting system is adequate for the resultant BPA and orders as required by Federal Acquisition Regulation. The Offeror shall submit a description of their accounting system and how it will adequately provide timely and reliable tracking and reporting of labor hours and other direct costs incurred under call orders.** **NOTE: Only the accounting system of the apparent successful Offeror will be evaluated.**
Could the Government please confirm that an OCI mitigation plan is not required for proposal submission of Volume 2 and will be required post award to the successful contractor?	**Per RFP Section E.2.C.V2: OCI Mitigation Plan will be required from the apparent successful Offeror.**
Could the Government please provide Attachment III as an unlocked native Excel workbook with all formulas intact and identify the required submission format?	**A0002 issued 7/23/2026 contained corrected Attachment III GPATS Price Schedule. Vendor input within Column G is the percent of discount vendor is agreeing to reduce their MAS LCAT rate.**

Does “all copies of any GSA Teaming Agreements” refer only to formal MAS CTA agreements? Must the Business Volume also include current GSA pricelists, modification pages, or other evidence substantiating each proposed GSA LCAT and ceiling rate?	**Yes, all applicable copies of formal GSA Teaming Agreements is required.** **No, this will be validated by proposal evaluation team**
Must the Business Volume also include current GSA pricelists, modification pages, or other evidence substantiating each proposed GSA LCAT and ceiling rate?	**No, this is not required.**
Factor 5 states that price will be evaluated for reasonableness and completeness. Will FEMA conduct any price-realism or technical-feasibility assessment of individual labor rates, or evaluate unbalanced pricing among LCATs and performance periods? If so, please describe the methodology.	**Adequate price competition is expected for this acquisition. This includes the total evaluated price and the proposed fully burned labor rates for the BPA Price/Schedule. The total evaluated price will be the total amount proposed using the Price-Worksheet provided with the solicitation.** **The proposed rates for the Price-Worksheet must be exactly the same as the proposed fully burdened labor rates (inclusive of any discount offered) for the BPA/Price Schedule.**
The solicitation states that, for an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé Joint Venture, the experience of both the mentor and protégé will be considered; however, "greater consideration will be given to the experience of the Protégé." Please clarify how the Government intends to apply this evaluation approach consistent with 13 CFR § 125.8(e), which provides that a procuring activity may require only some level of past performance and/or experience from the protégé, may not require the protégé to individually meet the same evaluation criteria as other offerors generally, and evaluates the joint venture based on the aggregate capabilities, past performance, and experience of both partners. Specifically, what level of Corporate Experience is expected of the protégé under Factor 1, and how will "greater consideration" be applied during the evaluation and be consistent with 13 CFR § 125.8(e)?	**Factor-1 Corporate Experience pertaining to JV (Joint Venture) entities: The RFP excludes consideration of experience from joint venture agreements or other legal entities, permitting consideration of the prime Offeror’s and proposed subcontractors’ experience, including SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé experience. Therefore, subcontractor experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé joint venture may be considered if the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its own role, scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results**
The labor-category table identifies only the Senior Project Manager/BPA Manager as Key Personnel, while Factor 4 requests resumes for all proposed Key Personnel and discusses the potential addition of other Key Personnel. Please confirm that the Senior Project Manager/BPA Manager is the only mandatory Key Personnel. Please confirm that additional key personnel resumes do not count against page count.	**Section E stating of Key Personnel in plural form, is clarified as singular. Only one Key Person is required for identification by name and resume; the Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager.** **The Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager may be employed by the Prime Contractor/Subcontractor/CTA (Contractor Teaming Arrangement).** **However, for JV (Joint Venture) entities, the Project Manager (Senior Level) / BPA Manager must be employed by the mentee/protégé.**
Regarding requirement 2.1.15. Can FEMA describe its current ticketing system or tracker for documenting/managing AFGP inquiries?	**There is no official ticketing system used at this time to track help desk inquiries.**
Given the importance of recent and relevant corporate experience, will the Government consider changing its requirement to only allowing contracts/projects performed within the past three (3) years to be submitted?	**Yes. Contracts/projects performed within the past three (3) years to be submitted, 5 is optimum.**
Given the importance of the prime Offeror's corporate experience, will the government confirm that work performed by a proposed subcontractor *as a subcontractor* will be evaluated less favorably than corporate experience of the Offeror or proposed subcontractor performed *as the prime*?	**Depends of the Prime/sub relationship. Corporate Experience pertaining to JV (Joint Venture) entities: The RFP excludes consideration of experience from joint venture agreements or other legal entities, permitting consideration of the prime Offeror’s and proposed subcontractors’ experience, including SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé experience. Therefore, subcontractor experience performed under a formal subcontract issued by an SBA-approved Mentor-Protégé joint venture may be considered if the offeror clearly identifies and substantiates its own role, scope, period of performance, workshare, responsibilities, and attributable results.**

Section 3.0 Deliverables - Item #3 - Transition-In Plan: States for 'Due By': Incorporate within initial proposal, a separate transition plan may be required at the Order level. Should the Transition Plan deliverable be incorporated into the Technical Approach, BPA Management Plan, an Appendix to Volume 1, or submitted as a separate attachment? Additionally, if included in Volume 1: does it count toward the Technical Volume page limits?	**RFQs for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
How many orders does the government anticipate awarding at time of BPA award?	**It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level.**
Please confirm the Estimated Hours populated in Attachment III are fixed, Government-provided values for evaluation purposes only, and do not represent actual anticipated Order-level staffing once Orders are issued under the BPA.	**Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**
Who is the current incumbent? And what is the contract number?	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
It asks for GSA teaming agreements, but are you looking specifically for the teaming agreements for the potential subcontractors on this specific engagement?	**A CTA is a GSA Schedule-specific teaming arrangement where both parties are considered prime to the agency under FAR Subpart 9.6. The entity identified as lead will be the Prime (unless otherwise identified per the CTA). https://www.gsa.gov/system/files/MAS-CTA-AGREEMENT.docx** **Note: Partner with other MAS https://www.gsa.gov/sell-to-government/step-1-learn-about-government-contracting/how-to-access-contract-opportunities/help-with-mas-contracts-to-sell-to-government/team-up-with-other-mas-contractors?_gl=1%2A4u78kp%2A_ga%2AMTE4MjM4MzI4MS4xNzg3MzM3NTYz%2A_ga_HBYXWFP794%2AczE3ODczNDIzMDIkbzIkZzEkdDE3ODczNDIzMjMkajM5JGwwJGgw**
Section B.6 states that BPA rates are ceiling fully burdened rates and that any new labor categories added during BPA performance must reflect the highest percentage discount established under the BPA. Would the Government consider revising this requirement to allow discounts for newly added labor categories to be negotiated based on the qualifications, labor market conditions, and pricing of the specific labor category being added, rather than automatically requiring the highest percentage discount established under the BPA?	**Later, during the performance of the BPA, it may become necessary to remove/delete or supplement the BPAs LCATs with new. When this occurs, the highest percentage discount will be negotiated.**
Please confirm whether the Letter of Commitment for a proposed subcontractor whose project is used for Corporate Experience must be included only in the Corporate Experience section, or whether it may be included as an attachment outside the 40-page technical volume limit.	**Letters of commitment do not count against page limitation.**
Can the government confirm if this is a recompete of an existing BPA with additional scope or if this is combination of two existing BPAs?	**GPTs BPA is partially a recompeted for BPA 70FA2022A00000002 (GPD Grants Training and Outreach Support Services, aka GTOSS), single award to Hite Consulting. Due to the realignment of FEMA Resilience (RSL), additional scope is added.**
The estimated labor hours in Attachment III appear to reflect a significant increase in anticipated staffing compared with the incumbent contract. Can the Government provide context for the increase, such as expanded scope, workload growth, new requirements, or planned surge support?	**GPTs BPA is partially a recompeted for BPA 70FA2022A00000002 (GPD Grants Training and Outreach Support Services, aka GTOSS), single award to Hite Consulting. Due to the realignment of FEMA Resilience (RSL), additional scope is added.** **Note: Surge support will be negotiated at time of order solicitation.**

Section C states that the Contractor may not use artificial intelligence unless expressly authorized by the Contracting Officer. Has AI been authorized for use on the incumbent contract? If so, what approved AI tools are available to contractor personnel, and does FEMA anticipate making those or other approved tools available under the resulting BPA?	**Per Section C of the RFP: The Contractor will not use or deploy the use of Artificial Intelligence, as defined by 15 U.S.C. 9401(3), unless expressly authorized by the Contracting Officer. The term ''artificial intelligence'' means a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations or decisions influencing real or virtual environments. Artificial intelligence systems use machine and human-based inputs to-** **(A) perceive real and virtual environments;** **(B) abstract such perceptions into models through analysis in an automated manner; and** **(C) use model inference to formulate options for information or action."** **NOTE: Contracting Officer approval will be required if automation technologies used by the contractor during performance of this BPA fitting the AI criteria identified above. This is not applicable for Government provided laptops with the required software, they have been cleared by FEMA's Office of Chief Security Officer.**
The RFQ defines a "project" as a single contract or order. Please confirm that a single-award BPA may qualify as one Corporate Experience project, provided the offeror describes only awarded and funded work and does not use the BPA ceiling or unexecuted scope to demonstrate project size?	**Contract vehicles are creditable however more emphasis is placed on orders with obligation and deliverables.**
The PWS states that the Transition-In Plan must be incorporated into the initial proposal, but the quotation instructions do not assign it to an evaluation factor or provide content requirements. Please confirm whether the plan is required with the quotation. If so, under which factor should it be submitted, what must it address, how will it be evaluated, and does it count toward the 40-page Technical Volume limit?	**RFQs for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
Would the Government please provide the name of the incumbent contractor?	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.**
Was this contract combined with another similar contract? If so, please provide the names of the contracts, contractors, and FTEs for both?	**Hite Consulting, Inc/70FA2022A00000002 is the incumbent. RFQ for new orders under this GPATs BPA will be issued as incumbent orders sundown. Or as new requirements for this GPATs BPA are identified during the GPATs BPA's ordering period.** **Note: Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years, and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**
Can the government please confirm that Attachment III should be completed and submitted in a separate excel file? If so, can the government confirm that three (3) separate files should be included in our submission?	**Submit the completed 70FA2026R00000007 Attachment III GPATs Price Schedule.20260729.xlsx within a separate email or include within the email with the Business volumes.** **Note: Electronic files must be submitted and shall not exceed 10MB or they will be rejected by the FEMA server. As necessary, files shall be submitted in parts in order to stay within the 10MB limit. A third email containing the 70FA2026R00000007 Attachment III GPATs Price Schedule.20260729.xlsx is actable.**
Can the government please confirm if a statement acknowledging amendments is sufficient or if a signed Standard Form 1449 or Standard Form 30 from the solicitation should be included in the Business Volume submission?	**A statement acknowledging the SF1449 and all amendments is sufficient.**

1. B.6 allows pricing from the offeror's or a teaming partner's Schedule, while Factor 5 says rates for prime, teaming partners, and subcontractors will be checked against the "proposed vendor's" FSS contract. It never clearly distinguishes a subcontractor from a GSA CTA member.	**A CTA is a GSA Schedule-specific teaming arrangement where both parties are considered prime to the agency under FAR Subpart 9.6. The entity identified as lead will be the Prime (unless otherwise identified per the CTA). Rates inputted within 70FA2026R00000007 Attachment III GPATs Price Schedule.20260729.xlsx may be a mix between CTA lead and member, and must be called out for verification by the proposal evaluation team.** **Note: Best discounted rates are requested.**
Please clarify whether a subcontractor that does not hold its own GSA MAS contract may perform work using personnel mapped to and priced under the prime contractor's awarded MAS labor categories. Alternatively, must every entity whose personnel or rates are included in Attachment III hold an applicable MAS contract and participate through a Contractor Team Arrangement? Please also clarify which entity is meant by "the proposed vendor" when verifying subcontractor rates against FSS contract rates.	**Prime must possess the valid 541611 MAS.**
2. The solicitation says orders may be FFP or T&M, but B.11 requires statements of cost, provisional indirect billing rates under FAR Part 42.7, fee and retainage reporting, and cost-element invoicing.	**RFP Sections B.11 and B.12 are boilerplate instructions for pursuing orders. Orders shall be issued with FFP Labor. On seldom occasion, an order may contain T&M Other Direct Costs (travel).** **Note: Fee (profit) is not authorized for ODC/Travel.**
B.10 and E.5 contemplate FFP and/or T&M Orders, while B.11 and B.12 require cost-reimbursement-style invoicing, including provisional indirect billing rates under FAR Part 42.7, fee and retainage reporting, and statements of cost by cost element. Please clarify which portions of B.11 and B.12 apply to FFP Orders and which apply to T&M Orders. For T&M Orders, should labor be invoiced based on accepted hours at the applicable fully burdened BPA labor rates, rather than through provisional indirect-rate billing?	**B.11 and B.12 are boiler plate instructions, issuing guidance for invoicing/billing that may not be applicable to reimbursement for FFP orders. Or may be applicable to seldomly placed FFP orders with T&M pricing for ODC/Travel.**
3. The PWS identifies GPATS as a Non-IT Requirement, but the solicitation includes requirements for contractor IT-system authorization, independent security-control assessment, ATO renewal, and privacy compliance. Please clarify the circumstances under which these requirements apply. Should offerors assume that performance will occur exclusively within FEMA-furnished systems, or could the contractor be required to develop, host, or operate a contractor-owned system requiring an ATO?	**This BPA and subsequent orders does not meet the government definition of IT products and services being acquired. Or require DHS/FEMA Chief Information Officer oversight. Therefore this BPA is for other-than Non-IT acquisitions.**
4. PWS 6.5 references compatibility with FEMA workstations using Windows XP and Microsoft Office Applications. Please identify the current FEMA desktop operating environment, Microsoft Office or Microsoft 365 version, approved electronic file formats, and any applicable Section 508, encryption, metadata, or records-management requirements for deliverables.	**Compatibility with current CoTS Microsoft Windows operating system and Microsoft Office Applications is required.**
5. PWS 2.1.15 identifies approximately 1,800–2,000 AFGP inquiries per month by phone and email, but the BPA QASP does not establish help-desk service levels. Please provide the anticipated hours of operation, channel distribution, seasonal or application-cycle peaks, average handling time, initial-response and resolution targets, call-answer or abandonment standards, escalation requirements, language or accessibility requirements, and the Government-furnished system of record. Please also confirm whether these standards will be established separately at the Order level.	**Actual hours will be detailed under individual orders. The number of inquiries per month (1800-2000) was included to assist vendor's in understanding the workload and determining relevant staffing plans for that requirement.** **Certification is not required. However, current knowledge and experience in the relevant disciplines (e.g., fire, emergency medical services, emergency management, communications, and grants management) is required as outlined in section 2.1 of the PWS solicitation.** **Bilingual support is not required.**
6. Please confirm whether the labor hours in Attachment III are evaluation quantities only or represent FEMA's current forecast of annual labor demand and labor mix. Should the Factor 4 Staffing Plan demonstrate the ability to staff the full Attachment III labor mix concurrently, or only demonstrate the capacity and processes necessary to respond to individual Orders? If the quantities reflect anticipated demand, please provide the expected allocation by GPD office, program, and work location.	**Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**

7. Please define the measurement population and scoring methodology for the QASP's 95% and 98% AQLs. Specifically, will each deliverable or report be evaluated on a pass/fail basis; how will multiple defects within one deliverable be counted; what constitutes an accurate, complete, or high-quality deliverable; and will a deliverable corrected within the five-business-day corrective period still be recorded as an AQL failure?	**This is addressed within the QASP "GRANTS PROGRAMMATIC, ADMINISTRATIVE, AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT (GPATS) BPA PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS SUMMARY (PRS)" table.**
9. The FASCSA clause includes an uncompleted effective-date placeholder, "DATE XXXX," and does not select Yes or No for the DHS, DoD, and DNI FASCSA Order applicability boxes. Please provide the completed clause and identify the FASCSA Orders applicable to this solicitation and resultant BPA.	**Fill-ins for FAR 52.240-91 SECURITY PROHIBITIONS AND EXCLUSIONS (DEVIATION 20-05) (NOV 2025) Alternate I will be completed, when applicable, for each individual order.**
10. B.7 requires travel to be billed in accordance with "GSA Federal Joint Travel Regulations." Please confirm whether the applicable standard is the Federal Travel Regulation, the Joint Travel Regulations, or another identified policy. Please also clarify the applicable treatment of local mileage, rental vehicles, taxis or rideshare, airfare, lodging, and travel performed by subcontractor personnel.	**The Federal Travel Regulation (FTR) is the official U.S. government regulation that sets the rules for travel and relocation for federal civilian employees and others authorized to travel at government expense. It is codified in 41 CFR Part 301–304 and is maintained by the General Services Administration (GSA) . Local mileage, rental vehicles, taxis or rideshare, airfare, lodging, and travel performed by subcontractor personnel is detailed therein.**
1. Attachment III – Price Schedule instructs offerors to enter data only in the yellow highlighted fields. However, the formula currently used in Column H (Discounted Rate) does not correctly calculate the discounted hourly rate based on the percentage entered in Column G (Percent Discount). For example, a Fully Burdened Rate of $100.00 with a 5% discount should result in a Discounted Rate of $95.00; instead, the current formula deducts 0.05 from the hourly rate, resulting in a Discounted Rate of $99.95. It appears the current formula in Column H is =SUM(F8-G8), rather than a formula that applies the percentage discount to the hourly rate (e.g., =F8*(1-G8)). Can the Government please confirm this issue and provide a corrected version of Attachment III?	**A0002 issued 7/23/2026 contained corrected Attachment III GPATS Price Schedule. Vendor input within Column G is the percent of discount vendor is agreeing to reduce their MAS LCAT rate.**
2. For planning purposes to best determine the team structure, will the Government please provide the current number and makeup of FTEs?	**Estimated hours are for evaluation purposes only. Hours are not uniform across option years and will be determined based on many factors such as Agency need and budget restrictions. GPATs RFP Attachment III contains the estimated hours for each LCAT based on 1880 hours for 1 FTE for 12 months.**
3. To assist offerors in developing realistic management approaches, organizational structures, staffing models, and supporting infrastructure, can the Government provide additional information regarding the anticipated ordering environment, including: a. The estimated number of Task Orders expected to be issued annually; b. The anticipated distribution of work across the major PWS task areas; c. Whether the estimated labor mix represents anticipated steady-state staffing supporting a single enterprise-wide effort, or the aggregate staffing expected across multiple concurrent Task Orders; and d. The anticipated number of concurrent Task Orders that may be active at any given time.	**It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level.** **Orders are expected to be issued as steady state.** **It is estimated anywhere between 5-8 is the initial projection even though it could always increase/decrease based on Agency need and funding level.**
4. Does the Government anticipate that Task Orders will generally align to individual PWS task areas, or will Task Orders typically require integrated support spanning multiple task areas?	**Yes, orders are issued to a specific project. This is due to funding appropriation.**